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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM.
MGU- UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATIONS MARCH, 2025.
SECOND SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG2DSCLIH100 –
FROM RESTORATION RATIONALISM TO ROMANTIC RHAPSODIES: MAKERS OF ENGLISH LITERATURE

ANSWER KEY

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark.

1. (d) Jacobean age CO1
2. (b) It promoted immorality and vice CO2
3. (c) the monarchy CO2
4. (d) Wesleyan Methodists CO4
5. (c) The introduction of actresses CO2
6. (a) Izaak Walton CO1
7. (d) All of them CO2
8. (c) Neoclassical and Romantic Era CO4
9. (a) George I CO4
10. (c) Ben Jonson CO1

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - Short Answers
Answer any six questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. **Bill of Rights** (1689), signed by William III and Mary II, limited the powers of the monarchy, ended the Divine Right Theory and strengthened Parliament - outlined constitutional and civil liberties - Parliament's supremacy over the monarchy - prohibited the monarch from levying taxes or keeping a standing army without parliamentary consent. CO3

12. Two-party system - the Whigs and the Tories - formalised during the Exclusion Crisis in 1681- on the question of whether James II, a Catholic, should be allowed to become the king of Britain - Whigs opposed James' succession - Tories supported the hereditary succession.
CO2

13. Samuel Johnson (Dr. Johnson) - one of the most influential literary figures of the 18th century - a critic, poet, essayist, biographer and lexicographer - written philosophical and critical essays – eg. "Preface to Shakespeare" (1765) - ***A Dictionary of the English Language*** - set new standards for dictionaries - ***Lives of the Poets*** - biographical and critical sketches of 52 English poets. CO3

14. Robert Walpole, Britain's first Prime Minister, served under the reigns of George I and George II - strengthening of parliamentary authority - rise of the cabinet system brought political and economic stability during a period of instability marked by the divided factions of Whigs, Tories and Jacobites. CO4

15. Periodical essays - a defining literary form in the 18th century - magazines of Joseph Addison and Richard Steele (***The Spectator*** and ***The Tatler***) - entertainment, education - promoted moral refinement, cultural awareness through discussion of art, philosophy and literature. CO3

16. Restoration era - ascension of King Charles II - a patron of the arts, restoring theatres and promoting artists - women onto the stage for the first time - developments in - vibrant literary age defined by wit, satire and social commentary - literature embraced the Baroque style - attained elegance and precision under the influence of French literary styles. CO1

17. Sir John Suckling - key figure among the Cavalier poets - best known for the poem "The Constant Lover" - witty, humorous verses celebrating themes of love and gallantry. CO1

18. Reign of Queen Anne (1702- 1714) - instrumental in shaping modern Britain - the Act of Union (1707) united England and Scotland to form the Kingdom of Great Britain - Whigs and Tories made their ideologies and policies more distinct and impactful - active foreign policy of Whigs party - promoted trade and commerce, strengthening England's economy and global influence - Tories worked to improve the economic conditions of farmers and landlords of Britain. CO3

19. Eighteenth century - growth of novel as an important literary genre in Britain - Daniel Defoe set the foundation for the modern novel - celebrated for his innovative story telling techniques (first- person narration) and his ability to craft narratives steeped in realism - *Robinson Crusoe* (1719) and *Moll Flanders* (1722) - stories, designed for a middle-class audience, combined entertainment with moral lessons - significant in the growth of English novels. CO4

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - Essay Questions
Answer any two questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Samuel Johnson (Dr. Johnson) - critic, poet, essayist, biographer and lexicographer –age referred to as "The Age of Johnson" - early poetic works - "London: A Poem" (1738) and "The Vanity of Human Wishes" (1749) - periodical essays in The Rambler and The Idler - offer reflections on morality, society and literature***. A Dictionary of the English Language*** (1755) - with over 40,000 entries, revolutionised English lexicography - included definitions, etymologies and illustrative quotations from various texts (literary, philosophical and religious) - philosophical prose works and critical essays like "Preface to Shakespeare" (1765) exhibit his exceptional literary talent. ***Lives of the Poets*** (1799-1781) - a ten-volume masterpiece - one of Johnson's most ambitious works - includes biographical and critical sketches of 52 English poets. CO4

21. Significant expansion of British Empire in the eighteenth century as a result of economic ambition, military conquest and maritime dominance - Rise of middle class played a significant role in the growth of Britain as an imperial power - top strata of middle class did overseas trading leading to the establishment of British colonies in different parts of the world like in the Americas, Africa, Asia and Pacific - Expansion of transatlantic slave

trade - transported millions of enslaved Africans to Caribbean and American plantations - Colonies like Jamaica, Barbados and Antigua - strong economic sources of Britain due to sugar production - British East India Company changed its motives from trade to establishing territorial power in India (after Battle of Plassey and Battle of Buxar) - Explorers like James Cook - claimed parts of Australia and New Zealand - Britain's maritime strength significantly contributed to the emergence of Britain as a major imperial power. CO1

22. The English novel emerged as a distinct literary genre in the 18th century. Enlightenment ideals: reason, individualism and scientific thinking - influenced the growth of novel - a turn toward realism, everyday life and human experiences - Several factors contributed to the novel's prominence - invention of printing press, growth of literate middle class and expansion of trade and empire - Influence of Cervantes (Spanish) and Rabelais (French) - Contributions of key figures like Daniel Defoe, Samuel Richardson, Henry Fielding, Tobias Smollett and Laurence Sterne - Role of female novelists like Sarah Fielding and Frances Burney. CO2

23. Whig and Tory factions rose to political prominence during the late 17th century – particularly around the time of the Exclusion Crisis (1679–1681) - Whigs stood for parliamentary supremacy, religious tolerance for Protestant dissenters, and opposition to arbitrary royal power - represent the interests of the commercial, urban, and more progressive classes.

Tories - supported the hereditary right of succession, regardless of religion - loyal to the monarchy and the Anglican Church - drew support from the landed gentry - more conservative in their outlook.

Two-party system became more formalized with the Glorious Revolution of 1688 and the establishment of constitutional monarchy - Whigs increasingly dominated politics during Queen Anne's reign and especially in the early 18th century under the leadership of Robert Walpole, often considered Britain's first Prime Minister.

Rivalry between the Whigs and Tories had a profound impact on literature - rise of the Whigs and Tories marked the beginning of organized party politics in England - ideological battles shaped government policy, influenced public opinion, and helped establish the principles of modern parliamentary democracy.

CO3

[15x2 = 30]